

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Apple pledged to invest** another \$100 billion in U.S. operations, adding to the tech industry's efforts to answer Trump's request to expand domestic manufacturing. **A1**
- ◆ **A rally in Apple** and other big tech shares led the Nasdaq 1.2% higher to just shy of a record, while the S&P 500 and Dow rose 0.7% and 0.2%, respectively. **B11**
- ◆ **Microsoft's AI chief** is wooing talent at Google, telling potential recruits that the operation he runs is a more startup-like workplace than the one they are in. **A1**
- ◆ **India's central bank** kept its benchmark interest rate unchanged as uncertainties about U.S. trade policy continue to cast a shadow over New Delhi's economic outlook. **A7**
- ◆ **Disney increased** profit forecasts for its streaming and experiences businesses, signs that it is gaining momentum in key areas as its legacy television business struggles. **B1**
- ◆ **Disney's ESPN** and TKO's World Wrestling Entertainment struck a deal in excess of \$1.6 billion to give ESPN exclusive rights to many of WWE's premier events. **B2**
- ◆ **Activist investor** Starboard has a more than 9% stake in Rogers Corp. and plans to seek more changes at the engineering-materials maker. **B11**
- ◆ **McDonald's said** same-store sales grew 3.8% in the three months ended June 30, beating analysts' estimates. **B1**
- ◆ **Novo Nordisk said** second-quarter sales of its Wegovy weight-loss drug soared 67% despite U.S. patients using generic versions of the treatment. **B1**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Trump said he expects** to meet soon with Putin about the war in Ukraine after an offer Russia made during a trip to Moscow by special envoy Steve Witkoff. **A1**
- ◆ **U.S. trading partners** are lobbying the White House for exemptions to sweeping new tariffs due to come into force on Thursday as countries seek ways to soften the blow. **A1**
- ◆ **Job losses in the eurozone** are set to rise as higher U.S. tariffs force Chinese businesses to look elsewhere for customers, the ECB said. **A7**
- ◆ **The University of California** agreed to talks with the Trump administration to resolve allegations that UCLA fostered antisemitism during campus protests in 2024. **A3**
- ◆ **North Korea accelerated** the construction of a launch site for spy satellites, including adding a seaport that could facilitate deliveries of parts from Russia. **A6**
- ◆ **Italy's government** approved a project to build the world's longest suspension bridge to connect Sicily to the Italian mainland at an estimated cost of \$15.6 billion. **A7**
- ◆ **Authorities in Belarus** unleashed a new wave of raids and detentions against government critics who took part in opposition rallies abroad earlier this year. **A7**
- ◆ **A United Nations report** backed the creation of a minerals trust to manage a stockpile of the commodities as global competition to secure them intensifies. **A6**
- ◆ **Died: Ion Iliescu**, 95, former Romanian president. **A7**

CONTENTS		Markets.....	B11
Arts in Review.....	A11	Markets Digest.....	B7
Business & Finance	B2-10	Opinion.....	A13-15
Business News.	B3-4	Personal Journal	A9-10
Crossword.....	A10	Sports.....	A12
From Page One.....	A8	U.S. News.....	A2-5
Heard on Street..	B12	World News.....	A6-7



Hiroshima Marks a Somber 80th Anniversary



TIME FOR REFLECTION: A boy prepared to float a paper lantern at Peace Memorial Park at the Motoyasu River in Hiroshima on Wednesday, as Japanese commemorated the U.S. atomic bombing of the city and Nagasaki during World War II. **A6**

Trump Sets 100% Chip Tariffs Unless Firms Invest in U.S.

President Trump said he would impose roughly 100% tariffs on all chips coming into the U.S. but exempt tech companies that have promised to

By Amrith Ramkumar, Natalie Andrews and Rolfe Winkler

manufacture domestically, a big win for Apple and other electronics firms worried about new trade challenges. Trump's announcement on Wednesday came at an event

trumpeting a new \$100 billion investment pledge from Apple. The company has increased its commitments in the U.S. but stopped short of moving iPhone production to the U.S. as Trump wants.

The new exemptions are a win for Apple Chief Executive Tim Cook, who has warned about the impact from tariffs on China and India. His company has so far avoided the most punishing levies. Cook also won tariff exemptions in the first Trump administration.

Many industry executives had been bracing for tariffs on all chip-related products that would snarl supply chains for everything from cars to appliances.

The president's comment that tech companies can avoid new chip tariffs by promising to invest in the U.S. formalizes an arrangement many executives already understood. Nearly every major tech firm has promised to put more into their U.S. operations, resulting in over \$2 trillion in new

pledges in the past seven months.

"If you're building, there will be no charge," Trump said. Industry analysts and executives say it is financially infeasible to make iPhones domestically, so Apple has moved some production to India from China and promised to make components in the U.S. The company's \$100 bil-

Please turn to page A2

◆ **Manufacturing struggles** to regain steam..... **A2**

U.S. Trade Partners Jockey For Levy Waivers

As countries seek clarity on measures, president boosts India tariffs to 50%

U.S. trading partners are lobbying the White House for exemptions to sweeping new tariffs due to come into force on Thursday, as countries seek ways to muffle the impact on their economies of President Trump's push to reorder global trade.

By Jason Douglas, Kim Mackrael and Gavin Bade

The diplomatic effort shows months of trade talks are far from over despite the run of agreements trumpeted by the White House in the past month.

The European Union, Japan and South Korea are among those that have agreed to pacts with Trump, while behind the scenes their negotiators continue to argue their case with U.S. officials for further relief for prized export sectors. Dozens of exemptions and carve-outs have already been allowed, for products including Brazilian orange juice and Chilean copper. At the same time, negotiators are seeking further clarity on U.S. tariff plans, with promised new levies on pharmaceuticals and semiconductors still to be officially announced.

Key details of many of the

Please turn to page A4

◆ **Tariffs create economic** ripple, not quake..... **A4**

How NCAA Fumbled Control Of College Football

By Rachel Bachman

Ever since it was founded over a century ago to organize college football, the NCAA has grown into the central authority for running—and policing—all of college sports. And for most of that time, it has kept that authority.

But a radical shift is under way. A handful of athletic conferences, built around football giants, are in the process of seizing power.

On Tuesday, the NCAA gave the four richest conferences—the Big Ten, Big 12, ACC and SEC—65% weighted voting across all Division-I committees. That means they can now muscle through many changes even if dozens of other conferences oppose them.

Those four had been quietly growing their influence for years. But Tuesday's move elevates them far above their peers and gives them unprecedented sway over the future of the game—and the billions of dollars it generates.

This group of conferences, not the NCAA, sells its own football broadcast rights and keeps the billions in annual proceeds. This group, not the NCAA, controls colleges' most valuable postseason, the College Football Playoff. And most significantly, this group recently launched its own enforcement arm, the College Sports Commission—a for-profit organization led by the former top lawyer at Major League Baseball.

How did this happen? How did the NCAA—a nonprofit founded in 1906 to rein in the brutality of major-college foot-

Please turn to page A12

INSIDE



U.S. NEWS

Ultraviolet radiation played a big role in the extinction of the Neanderthals. **A3**



BUSINESS & FINANCE

Regulatory rollbacks open door for Detroit to keep rolling out gas guzzlers. **B1**

President Expects To Meet With Putin

President Trump said he expects to meet soon with Russian President Vladimir Putin about the war in Ukraine, after an offer Russia

By Matthew Luxmoore, Alexander Ward and Alex Leary

made on Wednesday during a trip to Moscow by special envoy Steve Witkoff.

"There's a good chance that there will be a meeting very soon," Trump said at the

White House. He said it wasn't clear that Putin was prepared to make peace: "I wouldn't call it a breakthrough," but a product of weeks of negotiations. "We're here to get it stopped and get the deaths stopped," he added.

Trump is also open to meeting together with Putin and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, people familiar with the president's plans said. It isn't known when and where the meetings

Please turn to page A6

The Mystery of the Children in the Mansion

Couple with ties to China ran a surrogacy business that has prompted questions

ARCADIA, Calif.—In early May, after a baby was hospitalized with possible signs of child abuse, police showed up at a nine-bedroom mansion in this Los Angeles suburb known for lavish homes and residents with roots in China. Inside, they found 15 more children, none older than 3, living under the care of nannies.

The investigative trail led them to six

By Katherine Long, Ben Foldy and Sara Randazzo

more children at other homes in the Los Angeles area. A Chinese-born man and woman living in the mansion said they were the parents of all 22 children. Birth certificates list them as such. What mys-

tified police was that the children appeared to have been born all over the U.S., and in rapid succession.

Local authorities removed the children from the homes, placed them in foster care, and called in the FBI.

The mansion, it turned out, was listed as the headquarters of Mark Surrogacy,

Please turn to page A8

'Hook Up?' College Kids Schedule Everything on Google Calendar

◆ 'GCal' dictates students' every moment, from walks to class to when they go to bed ◆

By Haley Zimmerman

Early in her freshman year at Cornell, Vanessa Long got a Google Calendar invite from a classmate.

"Come over to my dorm?" read the invitation, scheduled for 10 p.m. Long clicked "yes," but she

was perplexed. Later, she realized this was a typical interaction on campus. Her classmate just wanted to hang out.

At Cornell, students use what they call "GCal" for everything. Long ticked off some examples: "What time they go to sleep, what

Please turn to page A10



No days off

Microsoft's AI Chief Poaches Google Talent

By Sebastian Herrera and Katherine Blunt

Microsoft hired one of the founders of Google's DeepMind to help it catch up in the AI race.

Now, Mustafa Suleyman is raiding his former shop for top talent.

Mirroring a tactic from Meta Chief Executive Mark Zuckerberg, Suleyman has been personally calling recruits, pitching them on the idea that the fledgling AI divi-

sion Microsoft created last year is a nimbler, more startup-like workplace than DeepMind has become under Google's ownership, people familiar with the matter said.

Suleyman, head of Microsoft AI, has offered hefty pay and the opportunity to help turn Microsoft's Copilot chatbot into a more formidable competitor to OpenAI's ChatGPT, the people said.

The company has poached at least two dozen executives

Please turn to page A5